

Problem

Given the following functions

$$x(t) = 2\delta(t), y(t) = 4u(t), z(t) = e^{-2t}u(t),$$

evaluate the following convolution operations.

(a) $x(t) * y(t)$

(b) $x(t) * z(t)$

(c) $y(t) * z(t)$

(d) $y(t) * [y(t) + z(t)]$

Step-by-step solution

Step 1 of 4

(a)

Evaluate $x(t) * y(t)$.

Substitute $2\delta(t)$ for $x(t)$ and $4u(t)$ for $y(t)$.

$$x(t) * y(t) = 2\delta(t) * [4u(t)] \dots\dots (1)$$

Apply Convolution property to this expression.

Refer to equation 15.78 in the textbook.

$$F_1(s)F_2(s) = L[f_1(t) * f_2(t)]$$

Refer to Table 15.2 for Laplace transform pairs.

$$L[\delta(t)] = 1$$

$$L[u(t)] = \frac{1}{s}$$

$$L[e^{-at}] = \frac{1}{s+a}$$

$$L[tu(t)] = \frac{1}{s^2}$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} 2\delta(t) * [4u(t)] &= L^{-1}\left\{\left(L[2\delta(t)]\right)\left(L[4u(t)]\right)\right\} \\ &= L^{-1}\left\{2(1)\left(\frac{4}{s}\right)\right\} \\ &= 8L^{-1}\left\{\frac{1}{s}\right\} \\ &= 8u(t) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the required expression for $x(t) * y(t)$ is $\boxed{8u(t)}$.

Step 2 of 4

(b)

Evaluate $x(t) * z(t)$.

Substitute $2\delta(t)$ for $x(t)$ and $e^{-2t}u(t)$ for $z(t)$.

$$x(t) * z(t) = 2\delta(t) * [e^{-2t}u(t)] \dots\dots (2)$$

Apply Convolution property to this expression.

$$\begin{aligned} 2\delta(t) * [e^{-2t}u(t)] &= L^{-1} \left\{ (L[2\delta(t)])(L[e^{-2t}u(t)]) \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ (2) \left(\frac{1}{s+2} \right) \right\} \\ &= 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s+2} \right\} \\ &= 2e^{-2t}u(t) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the required expression for $x(t) * z(t)$ is $\boxed{2e^{-2t}u(t)}$.

Step 3 of 4

(c)

Evaluate $y(t) * z(t)$.

Substitute $4u(t)$ for $y(t)$ and $e^{-2t}u(t)$ for $z(t)$.

$$y(t) * z(t) = 4u(t) * [e^{-2t}u(t)] \dots\dots (3)$$

Apply Convolution property to this expression.

$$\begin{aligned} 4u(t) * [e^{-2t}u(t)] &= L^{-1} \left\{ (L[4u(t)])(L[e^{-2t}u(t)]) \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{4}{s} \left(\frac{1}{s+2} \right) \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ 2 \left(\frac{1}{s} - \frac{1}{s+2} \right) \right\} \\ 4u(t) * [e^{-2t}u(t)] &= 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s} - \frac{1}{s+2} \right\} \\ &= 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s} \right\} - 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s+2} \right\} \\ &= 2u(t) - 2e^{-2t}u(t) \\ &= 2(1 - e^{-2t})u(t) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the required expression for $y(t) * z(t)$ is $\boxed{2(1 - e^{-2t})u(t)}$.

Step 4 of 4

(d)

Evaluate $y(t) * [y(t) + z(t)]$.

Substitute $4u(t)$ for $y(t)$ and $e^{-2t}u(t)$ for $z(t)$.

$$y(t) * [y(t) + z(t)] = 4u(t) * [4u(t) + e^{-2t}u(t)] \dots\dots (4)$$

Apply Convolution property to the expression (4).

$$\begin{aligned} 4u(t) * [4u(t) + e^{-2t}u(t)] &= L^{-1} \left\{ \left(L [4u(t)] \right) \left(L [4u(t) + e^{-2t}u(t)] \right) \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{4}{s} \left(\frac{4}{s} + \frac{1}{s+2} \right) \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{16}{s^2} + \frac{4}{s(s+2)} \right\} \\ &= L^{-1} \left\{ 16 \frac{1}{s^2} + \frac{2}{s} - \frac{2}{s+2} \right\} \end{aligned}$$

Simplify further.

$$\begin{aligned} 4u(t) * [4u(t) + e^{-2t}u(t)] &= 16L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s^2} \right\} + 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s} \right\} - 2L^{-1} \left\{ \frac{1}{s+2} \right\} \\ &= 16tu(t) + 2u(t) - 2e^{-2t}u(t) \\ &= 2(8t + 1 - e^{-2t})u(t) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the required expression for $y(t) * [y(t) + z(t)]$ is $\boxed{2(8t + 1 - e^{-2t})u(t)}$.